AARON KERMES

Instructional Designer | Learning Experience Designer
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SUMMARY

Learning experience designer with 13+ years across corporate, higher education, and K-12 learning. Designs and delivers end to end: needs analysis, curriculum and course blueprints, eLearning and instructor-led materials, LMS setup and administration, and evaluation. Builds learning tools in code, including an AI-powered curriculum platform on the Claude API and a browser-based practice module in plain HTML. Measures what ships: training and enablement programs with a 15% enrollment lift and a 42% reduction in handling time.

SELECTED WORK

Full portfolio at akermes.github.io

- Pathways: AI-powered K-12 curriculum platform built on the Claude API and React. Generates lessons, worksheets, and practice activities from a parent's goals and the student's level; in use by families.
- Flexible Novel Unit Practice Module: self-initiated, single-file interactive module that replaced lecture-only process training with a worked example, decision drills, a guided build with feedback, a peer review simulation, and a job aid.
- Data Literacy for Individual Contributors: scenario-based activity series for a corporate training client, built around charts generated in Python and sequenced from observation to decision.
- Consultative Sales Training and Evaluation: Mindtickle program evaluated across all four Kirkpatrick levels; 17% shorter calls, 12% more call volume, and a 15% increase in enrollments.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Instructional Designer, McGraw Hill, Remote — Aug 2025 to Present

- Design and build Grade 9 literacy content for the Summit! and Soar! program; manage more than half of the grade's ELA curriculum and serve as informal lead for the Grade 9 team.
- Build AI-assisted content in the MAIA platform with human-in-the-loop review; created prompt workflows for QA and content review and trained 11 teammates in individual sessions so the work could scale.
- Built a browser-based practice module to replace lecture-only training on a new build process, and prototyped a VBA macro to automate manuscript markup and screenmap population.
- Coordinate across design, editorial, product, and platform teams in Jira; developed Smartsheet trackers and step-by-step process guides used across the team.

Founder and Lead Instructional Design Consultant, The Learning Loop LLC, Show Low, AZ — May 2024 to Present

- Deliver instructor-led, asynchronous, and microlearning content for clients including Bundle, Cengage (ed2go), Western Governors University, Lumina Datamatics, and Summit Healthcare.
- Designed Bundle's Critical Thinking for Managers program and adapted it for new managers, senior managers, and individual contributors; built a data literacy activity series with charts generated in Python.
- Learning Designer on the Canadian localization of ed2go's 26-lesson Physiotherapy Assistant course: course analysis, revised outcomes and objectives, global edits, and a page-level revision blueprint reviewed with the SME and education specialist. Co-authored the course design for Western Governors University's graduate Cloud Strategy course.
- Built Articulate 360 training modules for Summit Healthcare and administered HealthStream: provisioning, role assignments, and completion reporting for managers.

Manager of Tools and Automation Support, Pearson, Remote — May 2023 to May 2024

- Led six direct reports and performed the Scrum Master role for a global learner-support program spanning the US, UK, China, and India.
- Introduced RPA and AI-augmented workflows that replaced manual legacy processes, reducing staff handling time by 42% and customer callbacks by 37%.
- Led the Microsoft Copilot adoption pilot: trained a six-person focus group, wrote SOPs and stakeholder one-pagers, evaluated adoption through surveys and three-month follow-ups, and reported progress against the roadmap to the senior director and SVP.

- Built and maintained Tableau and Power BI dashboards tracking team performance; served as unofficial product owner for the program's strategic roadmap.

Instructional Design and Development Analyst, Pearson Online Learning Services, Remote Jun 2021 to May 2023

- Designed and built 30+ graduate-level asynchronous modules in Canvas for nursing and cybersecurity programs at Maryville University, Regis College, and the University of North Dakota, working with 15 faculty and subject matter experts.
- Used LMS analytics (participation, completion, progress, and assessment validity) and end-of-course evaluations to drive revisions and guide new builds.
- Built gamified lessons and scenario-based activities in Articulate 360; managed editorial change trackers, metadata, and tagging across courses.

Manager, Student Recruitment Services, Pearson, Remote Feb 2018 to Jun 2021

- Led a team of 22 enrollment advisors supporting Arizona State University Online; hired, onboarded, coached, and ran quarterly performance reviews.
- Designed and evaluated a consultative sales training program in Mindtickle using scored role-plays and QA-rubric call reviews; coaching driven by the results cut call length 17%, raised call volume 12%, and contributed to a 15% increase in enrollments.
- Built Tableau dashboards tracking call time, conversion, handling time, and callbacks; reported KPIs and improvement plans with targets to leadership.

English Teacher and Department Chair, Kyrene del Pueblo Middle School, Chandler, AZ Jun 2013 to May 2017

English Teacher, Skyline Ranch K-8, Queen Creek, AZ Jun 2012 to May 2013

- Taught middle school English; chaired the department, led a professional learning community, and ran professional development for teachers.
- Used benchmark, formative, and summative assessment data to plan instruction, with a 17% gain in reading proficiency.

SKILLS

Learning design: ADDIE, SAM, Agile, action mapping, scenario-based learning, curriculum blueprints and localization, learning objectives and assessment design, facilitator guides, accessibility (WCAG 2.2 AA)

Development: Articulate 360, Camtasia, Canva, Figma, HTML, CSS, JavaScript, React, PowerPoint

Measurement: Kirkpatrick, evaluation plans, LMS analytics, surveys and focus groups, Tableau, Power BI

AI and automation: Claude API, prompt workflow design, Microsoft Copilot, RPA, VBA, Python

Platforms: Canvas, Blackboard, Moodle, HealthStream, SharePoint, Smartsheet, Jira, Asana, Salesforce, Mindtickle, SCORM, AICC, xAPI

EDUCATION

M.Ed., Learning Design and Technologies, Arizona State University May 2020

B.A., Secondary Education (English), Arizona State University May 2012